MMS · WORKFLOW GUIDE

How the Manuscript Management System works

A plain-language walkthrough of the full journey of a research paper — from account creation to publication — with pictures of each stage.

CCRI Manuscript Management System (MMS) · For authors, editors, reviewers, and production staff · Written for non-technical readers

What you will learn

1. Who uses the system (the four main roles)
2. The big picture — one paper's journey
3. Step-by-step: create an account and sign in
4. Author submits a paper
5. Editor checks the paper (screening)
6. Editor invites reviewers
7. Reviewers send their reports
8. Editor makes a decision
9. Author responds / revises if asked
10. Production prepares the final article

1. Who uses MMS?

Think of MMS as a shared office for a scientific journal. Each person has their own desk (dashboard). You only see the work that belongs to your job.

Author

Writes and submits the paper, uploads revisions, and approves proofs.

Editor

Checks new papers, invites reviewers, and records Accept / Revision / Reject.

Reviewer

Reads invited papers and writes confidential recommendations and comments.

Production Editor

Prepares proofs after acceptance and publishes the finished article.

Important: When you create an account you choose one role. An Author cannot open the Editor queue, and a Reviewer cannot submit papers as an Author. This keeps responsibilities clear and secure.

2. The big picture

Every manuscript follows the same path. Some papers skip revision and go straight to production; others need formatting fixes or a revised version before they can continue.



Figure 1 — End-to-end journey of a manuscript in MMS

1. **Create account** — choose your role and sign in.
2. **Author submits** — title, abstract, authors, and files.
3. **Editor screens** — pass, ask for formatting, or desk reject.
4. **Reviewers review** — invited experts send reports.
5. **Editor decides** — accept, ask for revision, or reject.
6. **Author revises** — only if the editor asks for changes.

7 **Production publishes** — proof, approval, DOI / publish.

3. Create an account and sign in

Everyone starts on the same two screens: *Create account* and *Sign in*. After sign-in, MMS opens the dashboard that matches your role.

CREATE ACCOUNT

Choose whether you are an Author, Reviewer, Editor, or Production Editor. Enter your name, email, institution, and password.

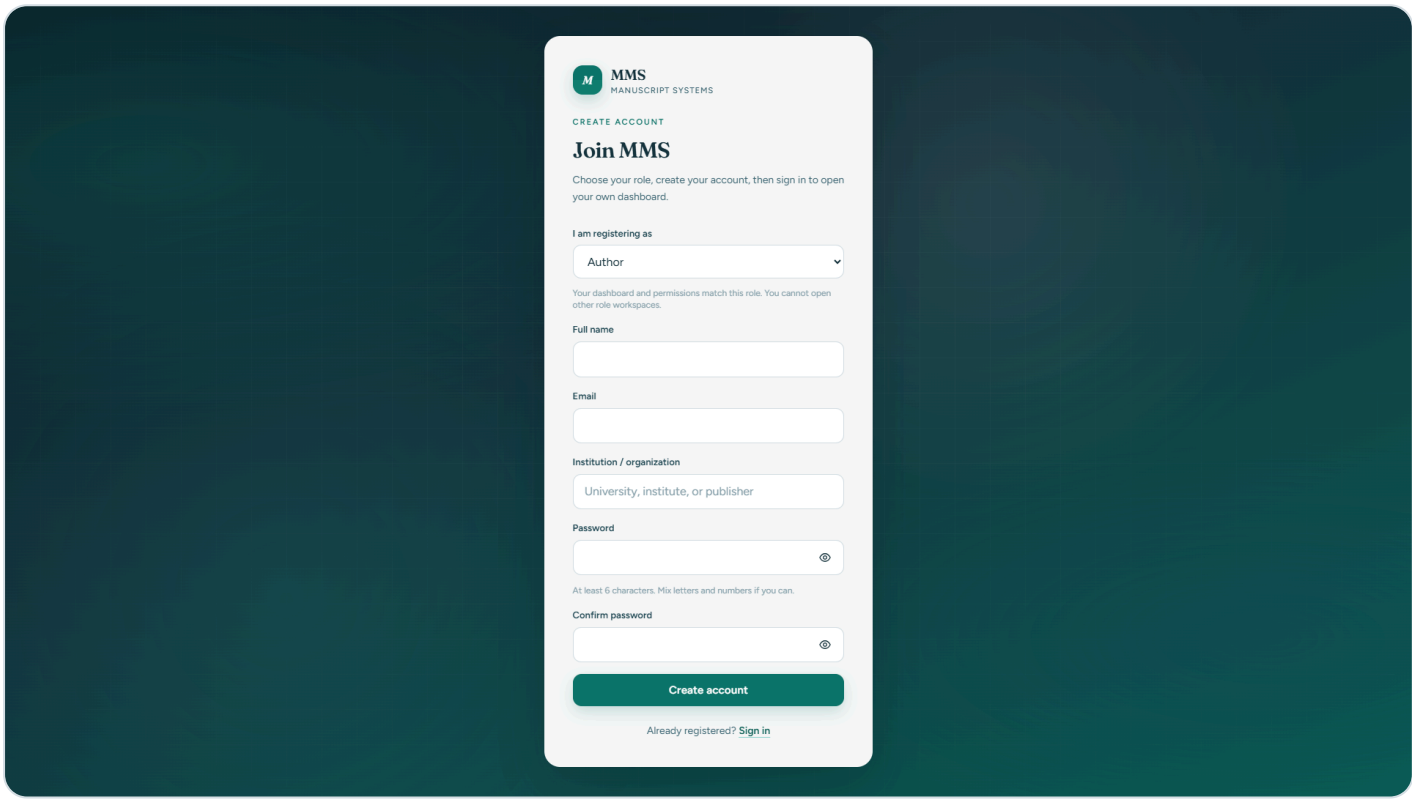


Figure 2 — Create account screen (real MMS page)

SIGN IN

Use the same email and password. The left panel explains that MMS covers submission, peer review, production, and publication in one place.

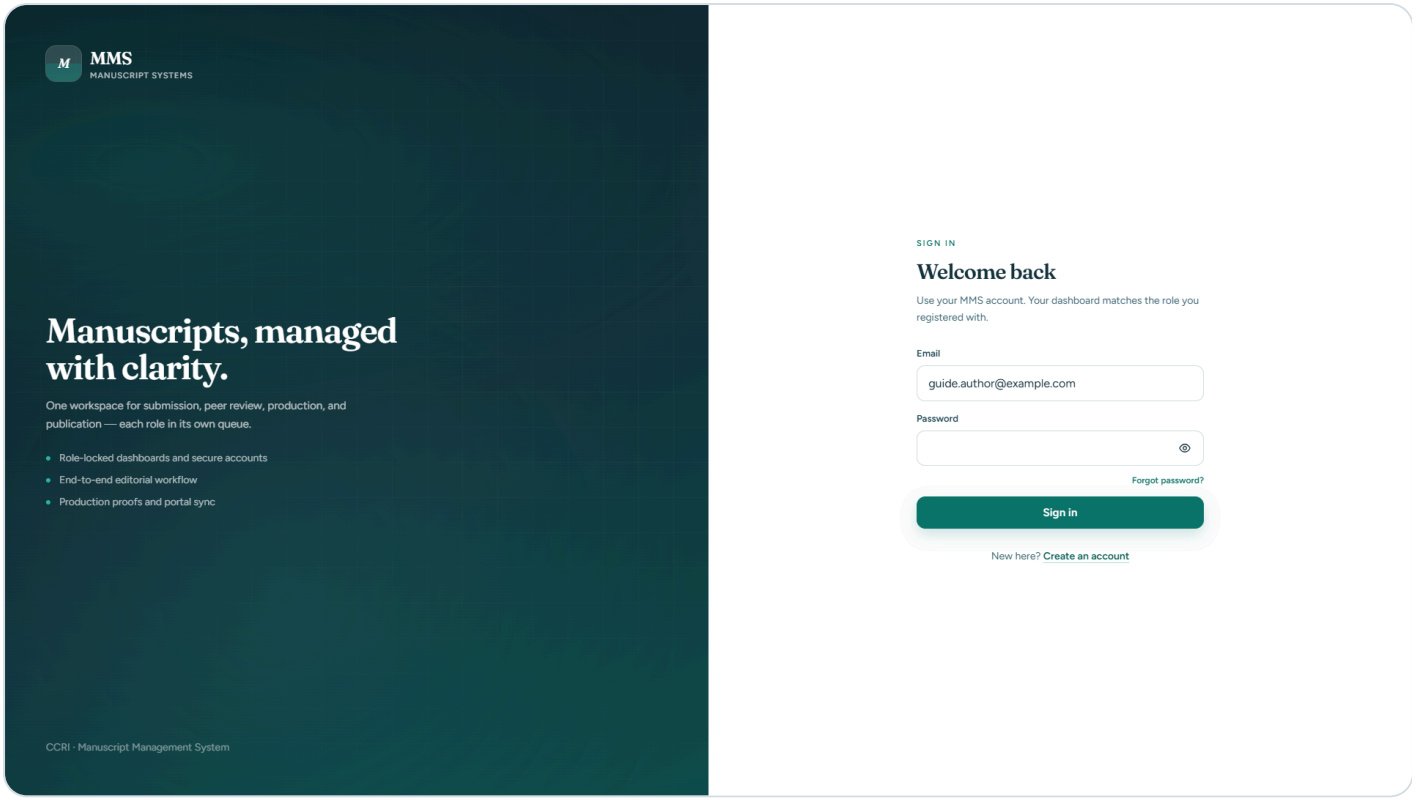


Figure 3 — Sign-in screen (real MMS page)

4. Author submits a paper

After signing in as an Author, you land on **Your manuscripts**. From here you can start a new submission and track every paper you already sent.

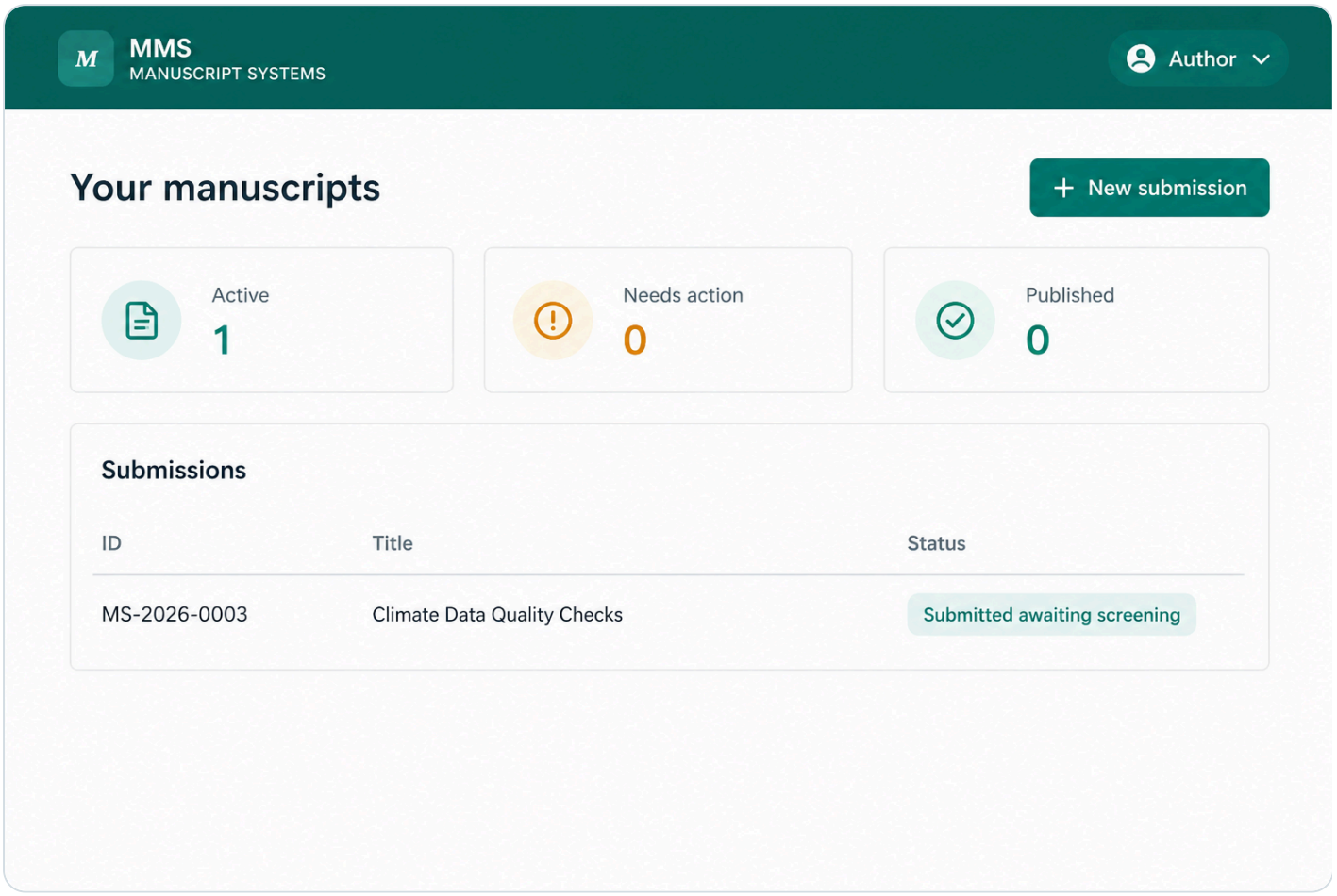


Figure 4 — Author dashboard: list of your manuscripts

Clicking **New submission** opens a guided form. You choose the journal, enter the title and abstract, add co-authors, upload the manuscript file (and optional figures), then submit.

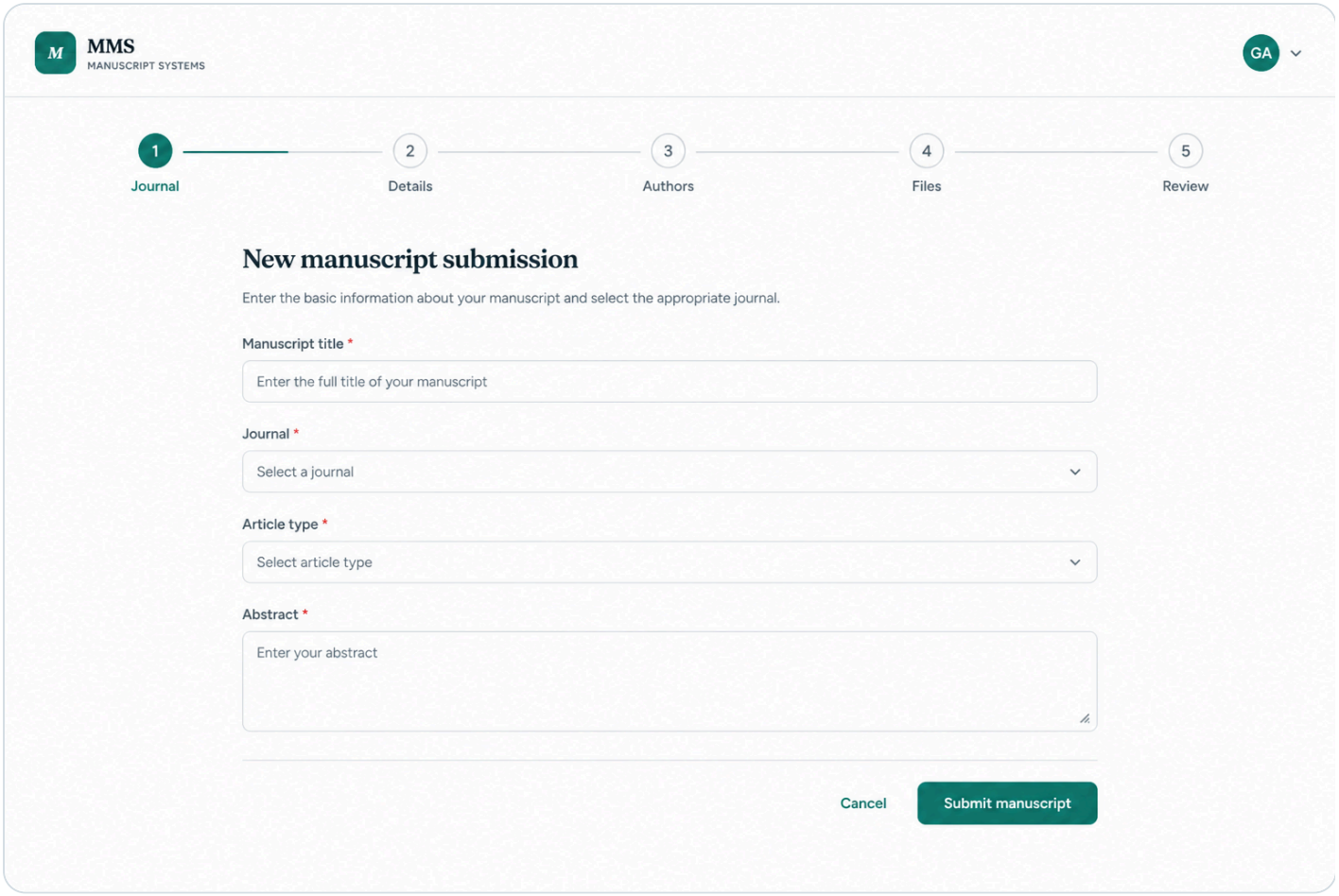


Figure 5 — New submission form

What happens next? The paper status becomes *Submitted — awaiting screening*. No further author action is needed until the editor replies.

5. Editor screens the paper

The Editor opens the **Editorial queue**. New papers appear under *Awaiting screening*. This is a quick quality check before peer review.

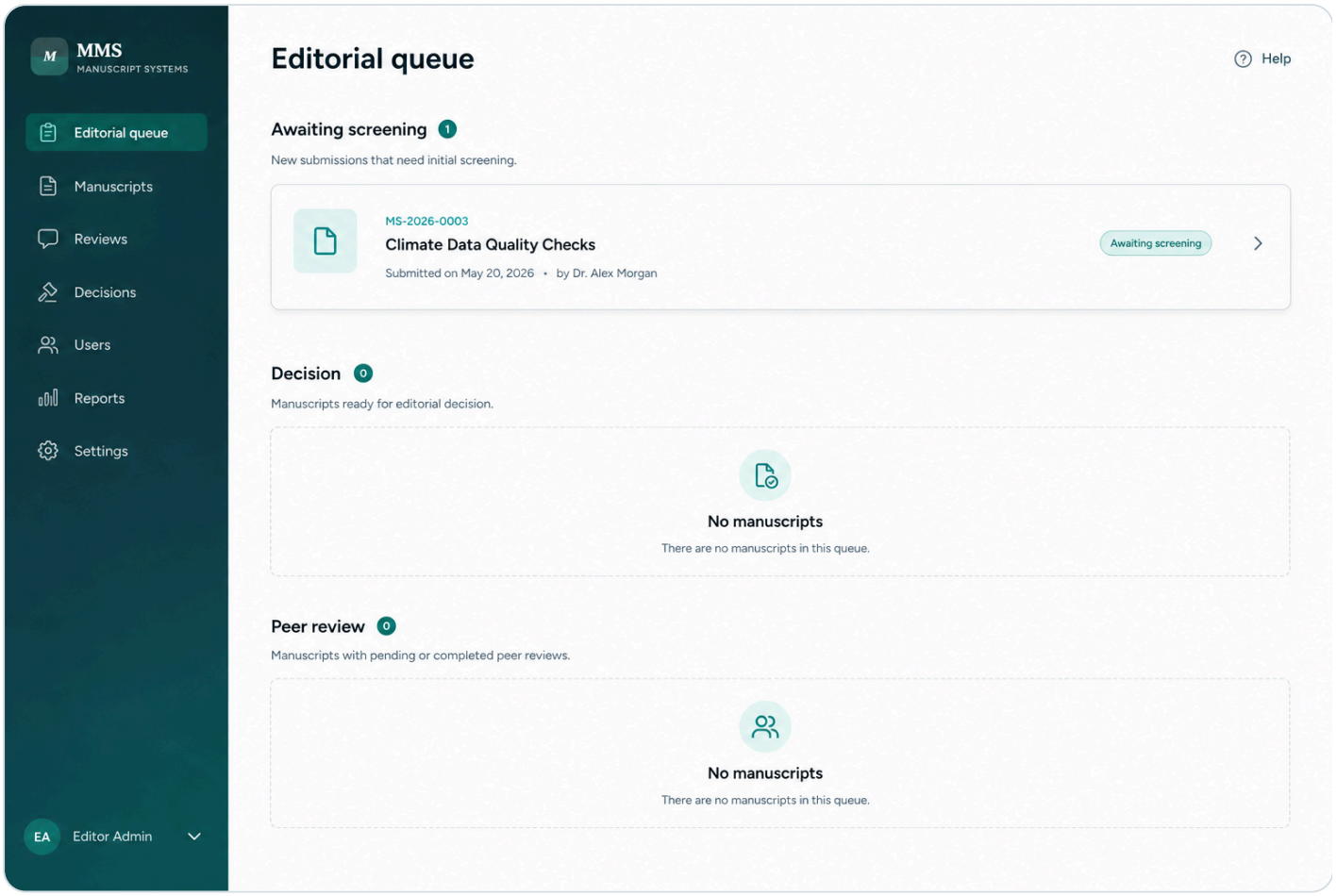


Figure 6 — Editorial queue with papers waiting for screening

On the manuscript page the editor completes a checklist and chooses one action:

- **Pass screening** — the paper moves to peer review (same editor can invite reviewers).
- **Request formatting fix** — the author must correct format issues and re-upload.
- **Desk reject** — the paper is declined without peer review (reason is shown to the author).

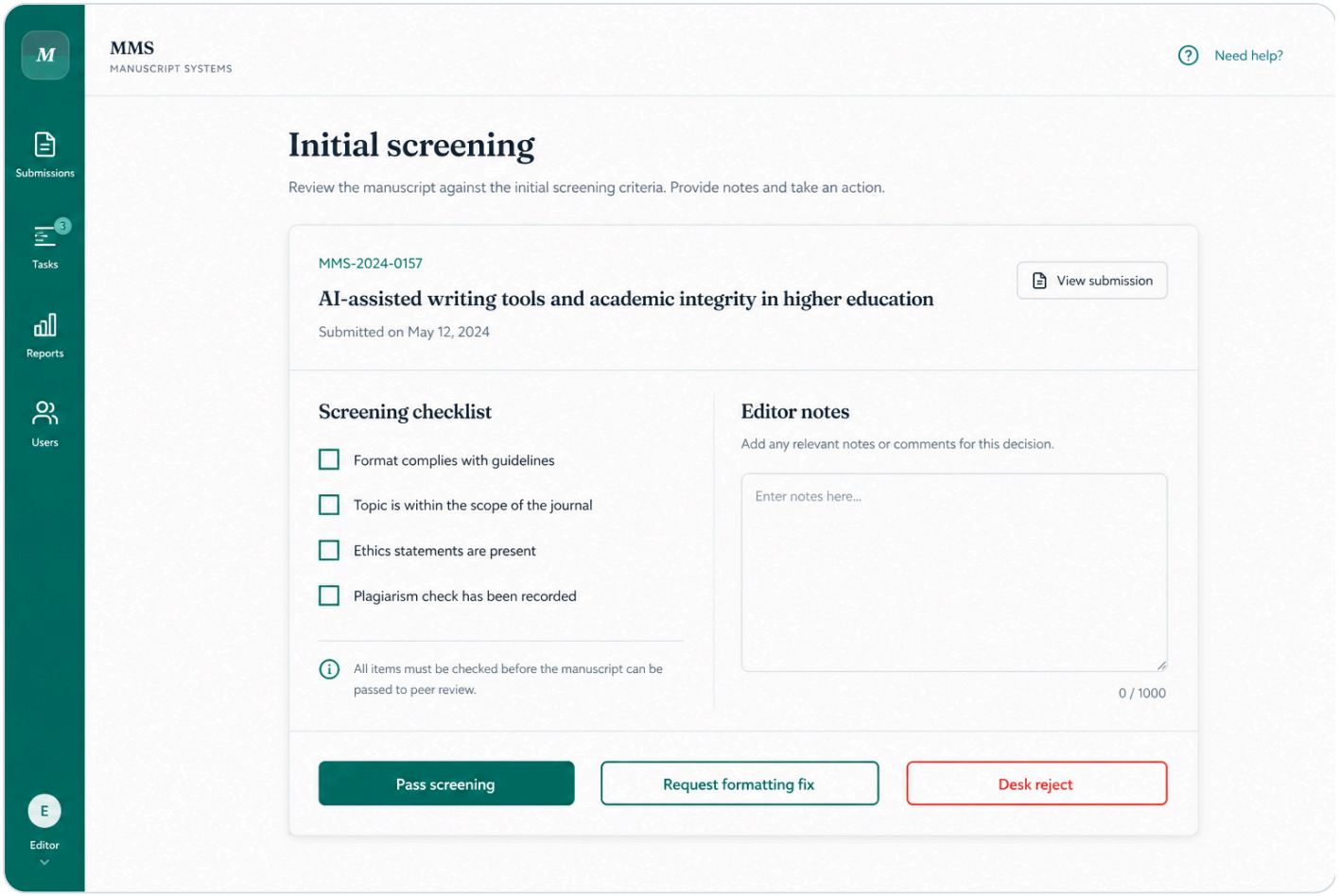


Figure 7 — Initial screening checklist and actions

6. Editor invites reviewers

After a paper passes screening, the editor invites registered reviewers. Each invitation has a deadline. Reviewers see the invite when they sign in to their own Reviewer account.

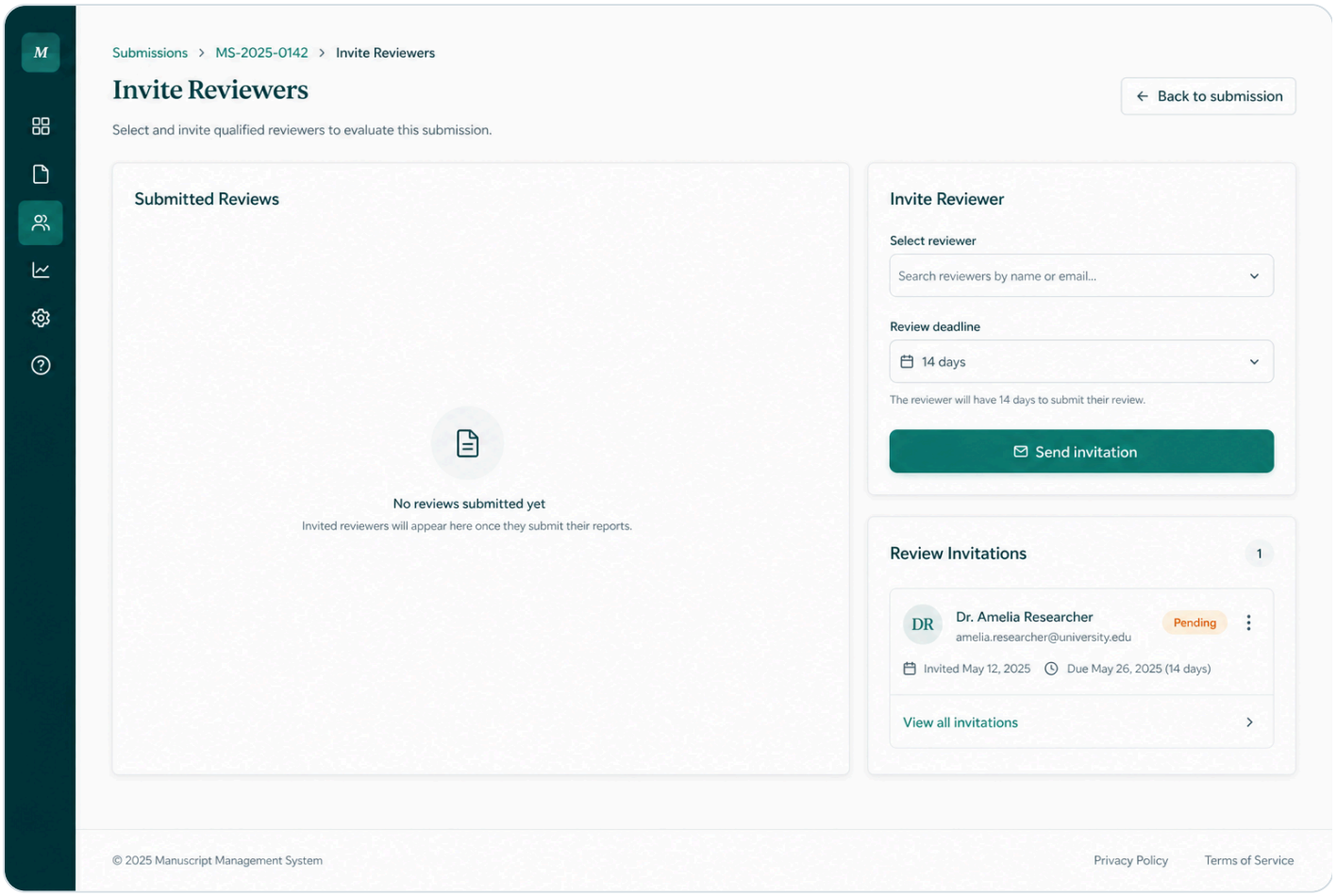


Figure 8 — Invite reviewers and track invitation status

7. Reviewers send their reports

A reviewer opens **Invitations**, accepts the invite, then fills in a structured report: summary, strengths, weaknesses, comments to the author, confidential comments to the editor, and a recommendation (Accept / Minor revision / Major revision / Reject).

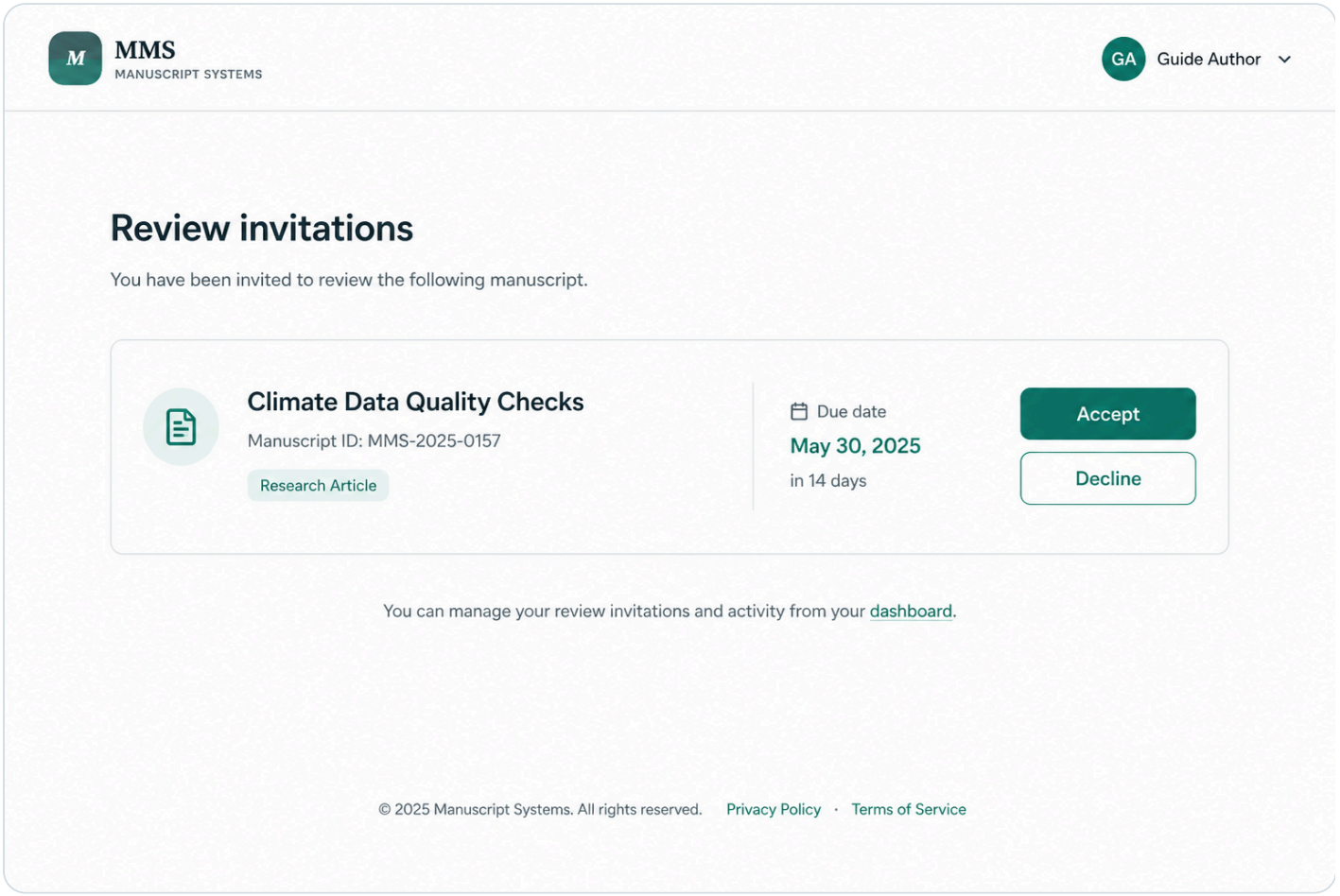


Figure 9 — Reviewer sees pending invitations

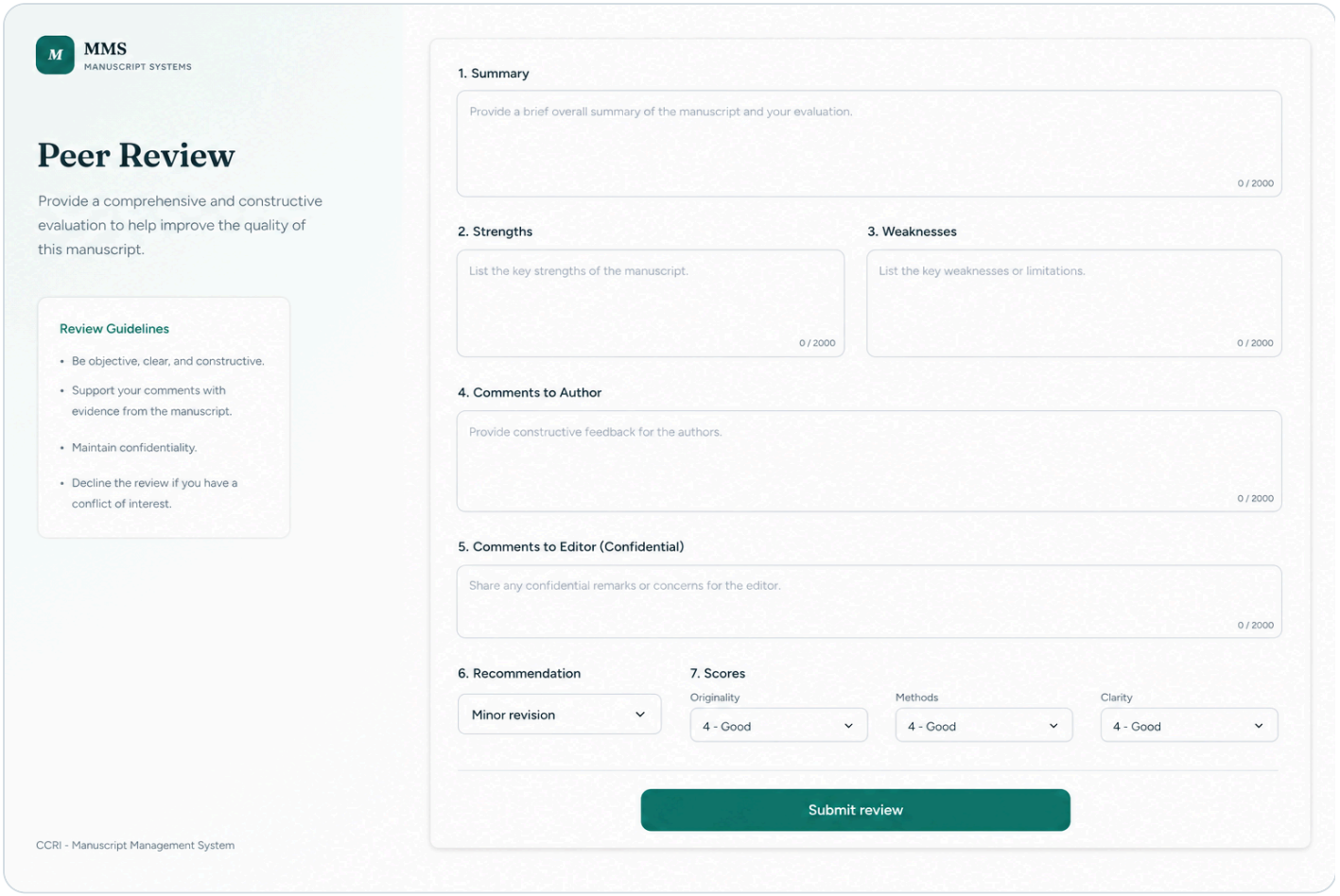


Figure 10 — Review report form

Privacy note: Comments marked “to editor” stay private. Authors only see reviewer comments after the editor records a decision (and reviewer names are shown as Reviewer 1, Reviewer 2, …).

8. Editor makes a decision

When reviews arrive, the editor reads the full reports (including confidential notes) and records a decision with a letter to the author.

- **Accept** — paper goes to Production.
- **Minor / Major revision** — author must revise and reply.
- **Reject** — process ends; author can still read the feedback.

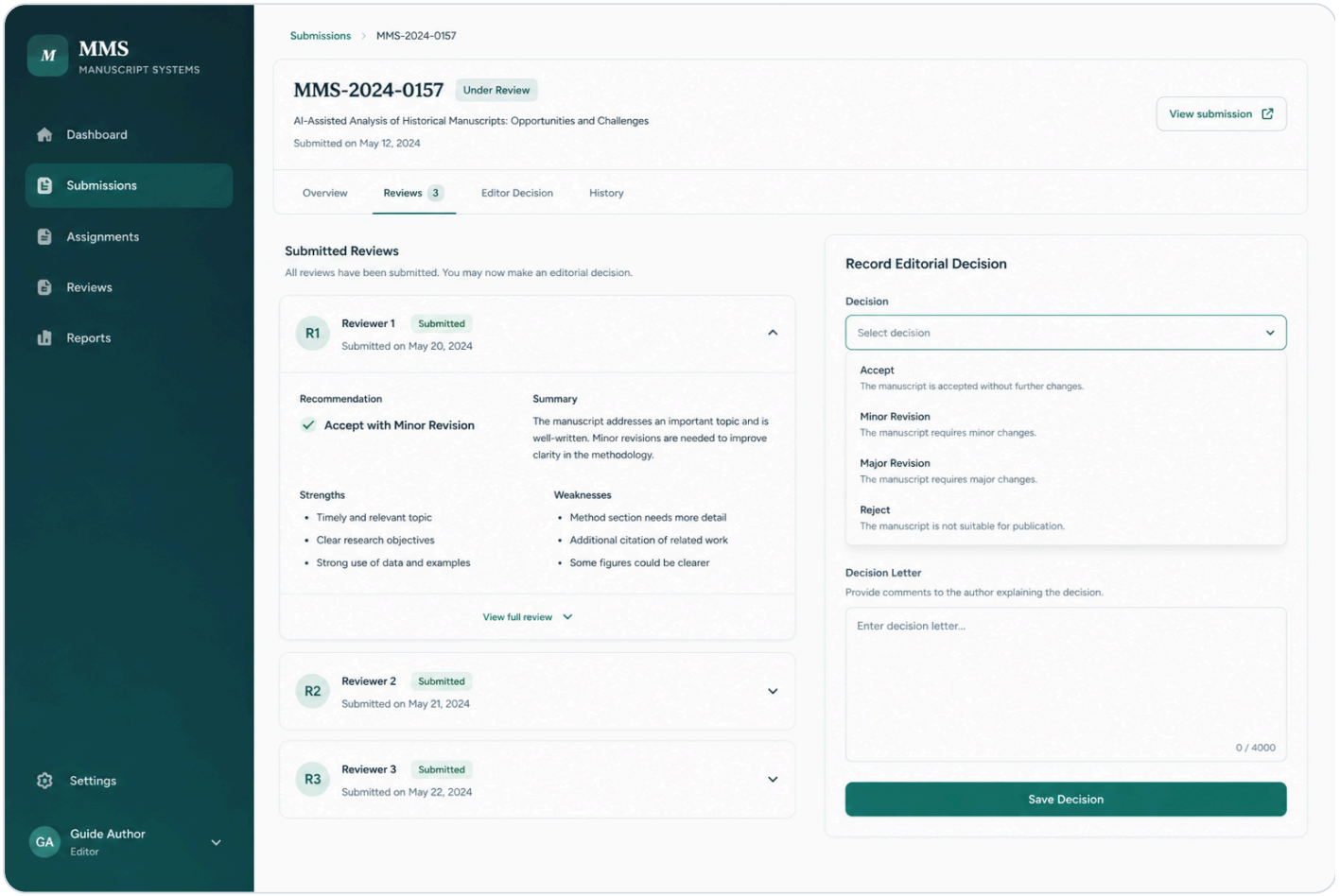


Figure 11 — Submitted reviews and Record decision panel

9. Author responds or revises

If revision is requested, the author opens the manuscript, reads the editor letter and reviewer comments, then uploads a revised file and a response letter.

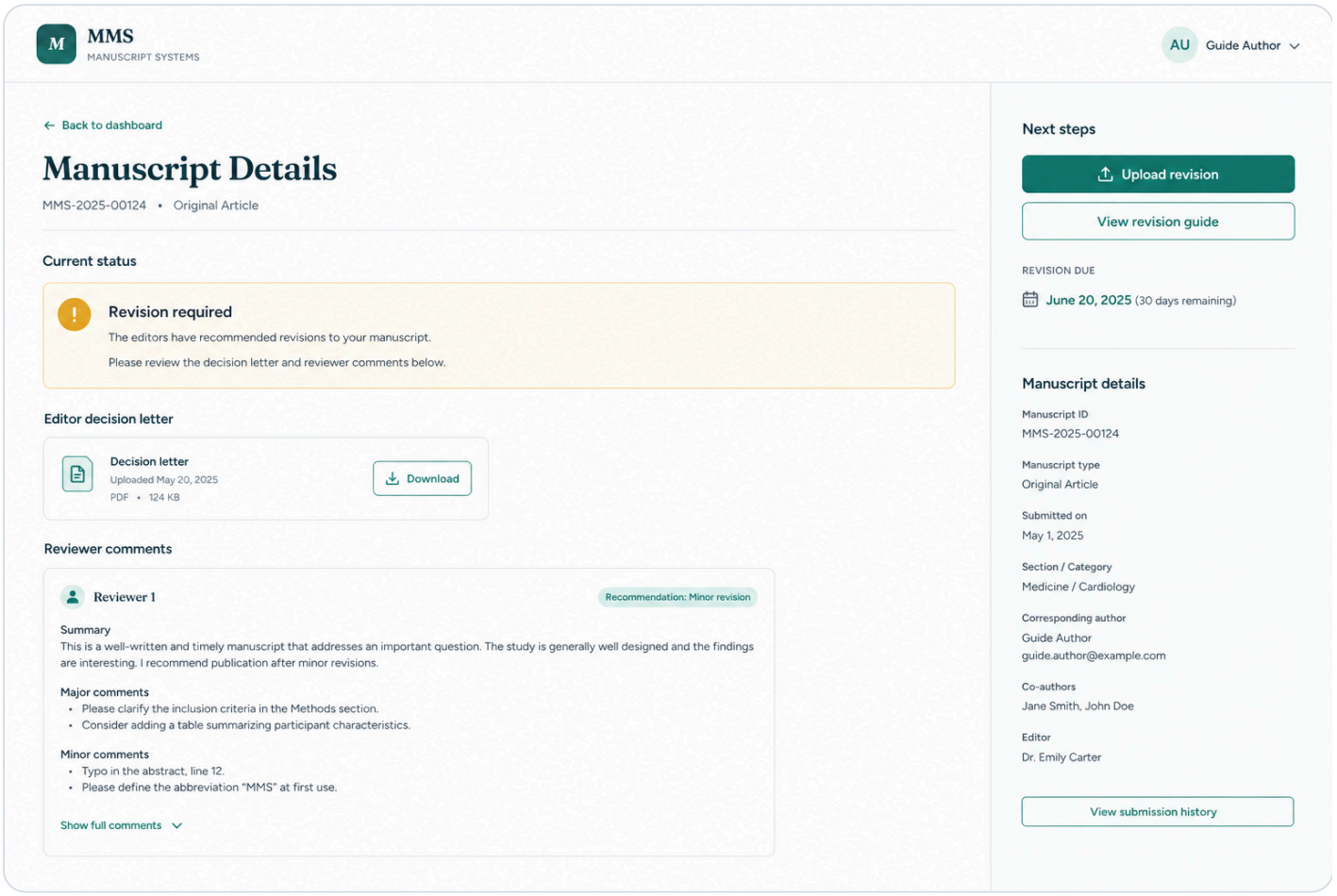


Figure 12 — Author view with decision letter and reviewer comments

After re-submission, the editor (and often the same reviewers) continue the process until a final Accept or Reject.

10. Production prepares the final article

Accepted papers appear in the **Production queue**. Production staff prepare a proof, send it to the author for approval, then publish and assign a DOI.

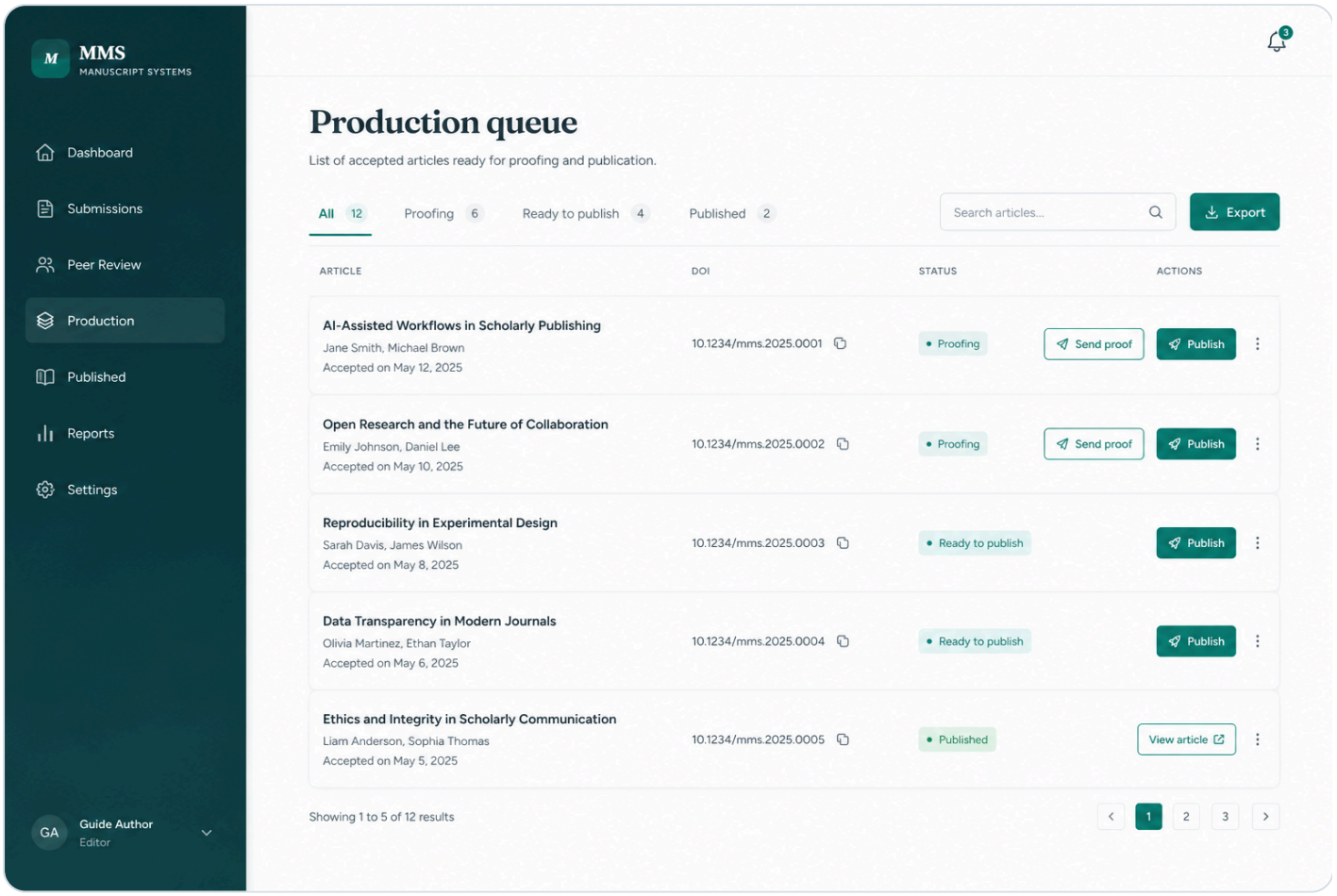


Figure 13 — Production queue for accepted manuscripts

Quick reference — statuses you may see

- **Draft** — saved but not submitted
- **Submitted** — waiting for editor screening
- **Formatting revision requested** — fix format, then re-upload
- **Under peer review** — reviewers are working
- **Revision required** — author must revise
- **Accepted** — moving to production
- **Proof ready** — author should review the proof
- **Published** — article is live (often with a DOI)
- **Rejected** — declined (desk or after review)

One sentence summary: Authors submit → Editors screen and invite reviewers → Reviewers advise → Editors decide → Authors revise if needed → Production publishes.

Document: MMS Workflow Guide · Figures 2–3 are live screenshots from the MMS website; Figures 1 and 4–13 are branded UI illustrations matching the same product screens for print clarity. Open `MMS-Workflow-Guide.html` in a browser, or use the generated PDF.